

FOR PEOPLE IN RETAIL AFFECTED BY VIOLENCE AND ABUSE AT WORK

It happened at work. It's still with you.

Shirley's supports retail workers living with the effects of abuse, threats and violence on the shop floor. You don't have to tell us what happened. You don't have to carry it on your own.

[Talk to us](#)

[See how we help](#)

Beginning locally in Solihull and the West Midlands.

Abuse is not part of the job.

It usually starts with something staff are expected to do: stopping a theft, asking for ID, refusing a sale. Most of it never reaches a police officer, and much of it is never reported at all.

1,600

incidents of violence and abuse against UK retail staff every day, close to four times the level before the pandemic.

BRC Crime Survey, 2024/25

2 in 5

retail workers feel anxious about coming to work or are thinking about leaving.

USDAW and Retail Trust surveys, 2022-2025

71%

of the retail workers we surveyed were offered no support afterwards.

Shirley's survey of 42 local retail workers, 2026

"[A short, real quote from a local retail worker, used with their

permission.]"

[Role, store type — no name unless they choose]

[Photo: documentary style — a real shop floor or till after closing, quiet, no posed smiles. Photographed locally with consent.]

HOW WE HELP

What happens afterwards matters.

We don't investigate incidents or decide who was to blame. We focus on you: how you're feeling, what's changed, and what might help you feel steady again. There's more than one way in.

MOVE

Group movement and accessible fitness, at your own pace. Regular activity is one of the best-evidenced ways to ease anxiety and low mood.

TALK

Small, informal conversations with people who understand retail.
Nobody is ever asked to describe what happened.

CONNECT

Meet others who've been through something similar, so you're not the only one in the room who gets it.

BE SUPPORTED

Help finding the right next step, including NHS Talking Therapies, your GP and Retail Trust, when you need more than we can offer.

What you can expect from us

You decide how much to share. Saying nothing about what happened is completely fine.

You can stop at any time. No pressure to come back, and no explanation needed.

We'll tell you what happens next before it happens.

We won't share what you tell us with your employer [confirm confidentiality terms and any safeguarding exceptions].

Programmes

[Photo: a real Beyond the Tills group session]

IN DEVELOPMENT

Beyond the Tills

A group programme of around six weeks for people who've experienced abuse or violence at work. It's about rebuilding confidence, finding steady ground and knowing where to turn.

[Register your interest](#)

[Photo: a real MOVE session — people moving, not posing]

PILOTING NOW

MOVE

Weekly movement sessions with music, for every fitness level. A way to feel better in your body and spend time with people who understand the job. It's for wellbeing, not a replacement for therapy.

[Ask about the next session](#)

FOR EMPLOYERS AND PARTNERS

Your team carries what happens on the shop floor.

Cameras and guards deter incidents. They don't help the person afterwards. We work alongside your existing support, with managers as well as staff, and we measure what changes.

We work with retailers, retail destinations, local authorities, community organisations and funders on referrals, commissioned programmes, venues and sponsorship.

[Start a conversation](#)

Talk to us

Call, text or email. You don't need to explain why you're getting in touch.

07913 204385

[Hello@ShirleyswellbeingCIC.co.uk](mailto>Hello@ShirleyswellbeingCIC.co.uk)

Shirley's is not an emergency service

In immediate danger: **999**

Urgent but not an emergency: **NHS 111**

Someone to talk to, any time: **Samaritans 116 123**

Retail Trust helpline: **[number to confirm]**